

The human-led, AI-augmented bid practice

Agents prepare and coordinate. People direct, challenge, decide and approve.

CAPTURE	PURSUIT	HANDOVER
Agents Surface signals and assemble context. People Judge strategic fit and whether to pursue.	Agents Analyse, retrieve, compare and check. People Set strategy and accept commitments.	Agents Structure promises, risks and learning. People Confirm what was sold and lead mobilisation.

1 Business outcome	2 Trusted context	3 Agents and tools
4 Evaluate and refine	5 Human decision gates	6 Measure and learn

12 questions | One workflow | One credible test

Assess one real bid workflow.

Avoid rating the organisation in the abstract. Use a live, recent or representative pursuit and judge what is visible in the work today.

THE CENTRAL
REFRAME

Design the decision, context, controls and human gate before choosing the agent.

VISIBLE	PARTIAL	UNCLEAR
Clear, named and evidenced in the workflow.	Present in places, but inconsistent or dependent on individuals.	Not yet defined, tested or owned.

Do not chase a single maturity score

The pattern across six areas matters more than the total. A gap is useful evidence: it shows what to resolve before you spend more, depend on the agent or expand its authority.

Work through the twelve statements, mark each one Visible, Partial or Unclear, and use the challenge prompt to test whether the workflow is genuinely ready.

Areas 1 and 2 of 6

01 | DIAGNOSTIC AREA

Business outcome

1. The workflow begins with a named business or bid decision, not a general ambition to use AI or save time.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

2. The accountable people agree what a useful output must contain and what would make it unsafe or misleading.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

CHALLENGE PROMPT

Which consequential decision should this work make easier to reach?

02 | DIAGNOSTIC AREA

Trusted context

3. The required tender, customer, commercial, technical and organisational sources are identified, current and available.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

4. The workflow distinguishes approved evidence from stale, unverified, confidential or other-customer material.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

CHALLENGE PROMPT

Could a reviewer trace every important output to an authorised source?

Areas 3 and 4 of 6

03 | DIAGNOSTIC AREA

Agents, tools and roles

5. The agent contribution is bounded and specific: retrieving, comparing, checking, structuring or routing work.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

6. A named person is responsible for directing the work, resolving exceptions and deciding whether the output is used.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

CHALLENGE PROMPT

Is the agent's job clear enough without saying 'help with the bid'?

04 | DIAGNOSTIC AREA

Evaluation and refinement

7. The team can test accuracy, completeness, source use and omissions against a human-reviewed example or baseline.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

8. The workflow defines what happens when evidence is uncertain, sources conflict or the agent fails.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

CHALLENGE PROMPT

How will you know it is wrong before it affects the pursuit?

Areas 5 and 6 of 6

05 | DIAGNOSTIC AREA

Human decision gates

9. Named people retain authority for qualification, strategy, commitments, risk acceptance and submission.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

10. Each gate states what evidence is required, who approves and how the decision is recorded.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

CHALLENGE PROMPT

Who can say yes, no or not yet?

06 | DIAGNOSTIC AREA

Measurement and learning

11. The test measures more than speed: rework, waiting, omissions, corrections and whether decisions happen earlier.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

12. Approved learning can improve the next pursuit without allowing prior answers or assumptions to become truth.

☐ Visible ☐ Partial ☐ Unclear

CHALLENGE PROMPT

What could this bid teach the system that the next team can use safely?

Choose the first workflow worth testing.

Your strongest first use case sits where recurrence and consequence, trusted context and evaluation, and a safe controlled test intersect.

01	THE WORK RECURS AND MATTERS It creates a meaningful commercial, risk, capacity or quality consequence.
02	THE CONTEXT CAN BE TRUSTED The right evidence is available and a knowledgeable person can judge the output.
03	THE TEST CAN BE CONTROLLED Historical, synthetic or otherwise safe material allows learning before live delivery depends on it.

Write the use case in one sentence

When [named user] needs to [job or decision], the workflow will [bounded agent contribution] using [authorised context], before [named person] decides [human gate].

Recurring Does it happen often enough to learn from?	Consequential Would improvement matter to growth, risk or capacity?	Grounded Are inputs available, authorised and current?	Evaluable Can a knowledgeable person judge success?	Controllable Can it be tested safely before live reliance?
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Define the experiment before building it.

Complete these six fields with the people who own the work, the evidence and the decision. Keep the first test deliberately narrow.

01 USER AND JOB Who needs what decision? Name the user, task or decision, current friction and practical consequence.	02 AGENT BOUNDARY What may the agent do? State what it may prepare or coordinate, and what it must not do.
03 TRUSTED CONTEXT What may it use? List sources, owners, access conditions and rules for stale or conflicting information.	04 HUMAN GATE Who remains accountable? Name who reviews evidence, resolves exceptions and decides whether work advances.
05 EVALUATION How will you detect failure? Set the baseline, checks, tolerances, failure modes and escalation route.	06 TEST AND DECISION What will 30 days prove? Choose controlled material, reviewers and measures, then define stop, refine or expand.

Use the guide. Then go deeper.

The diagnostic helps you identify where a credible test may begin. The forthcoming Ignis white paper will explore the operating model needed to turn isolated experiments into a repeatable, governed bid capability.

1	Use the diagnostic Assess one real bid workflow with the people who own the decision and evidence.
2	Choose the controlled test Write the use case, make the human gate explicit and define what 30 days should prove.
3	Get the white paper Return to the resource page for the deeper paper when it is released.
4	Book a practice review Use the completed diagnostic as the starting point for a tailored conversation.

GO DEEPER

**The white paper
is coming next**

ignisleadership.com/insights

About Yorik Tisseau

Yorik brings more than 15 years of bid leadership to AI and operating-model transformation. Through Ignis Leadership, he helps organisations redesign the practice behind complex bids so people, workflows and agents can work together with clear human accountability.